

Condense

Words on a misted window

One word appears.
Others gather around it.
Then the glass becomes quiet again.

INTERACTIVE ARTWORK / MIST

Project documentation · September 2026

A small habit, translated into language.

When it rains, a thin layer of mist gathers on the glass. We often draw something on it without thinking: a name, a flower, a face, or simply a line.

These marks have no particular purpose and never remain for long, but one mark often leads to another.

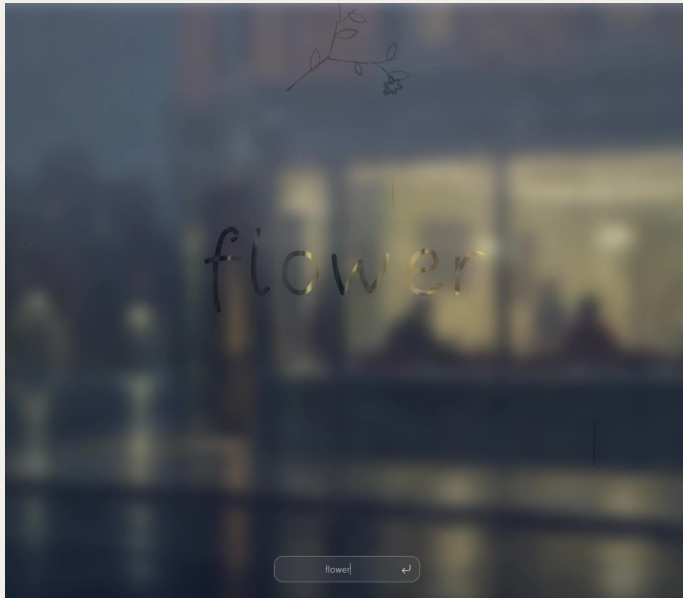
Condense grows out of this small habit. Thoughts move in a similar way: one word appears, brings other words and new images with it, then slowly fades.



01:00 / An idle mark on the glass

Write. Associate. Let go.

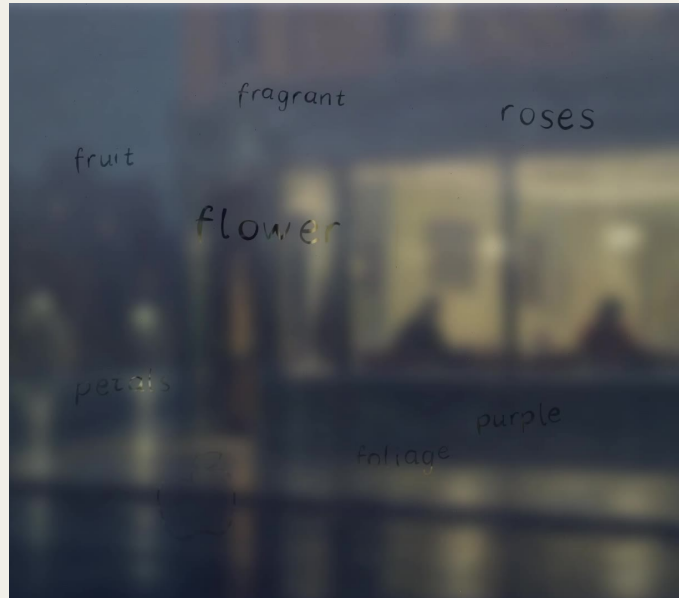
The interface follows a short cycle, with space for hesitation and return.



01 Write

00:36 / VIDEO FRAME

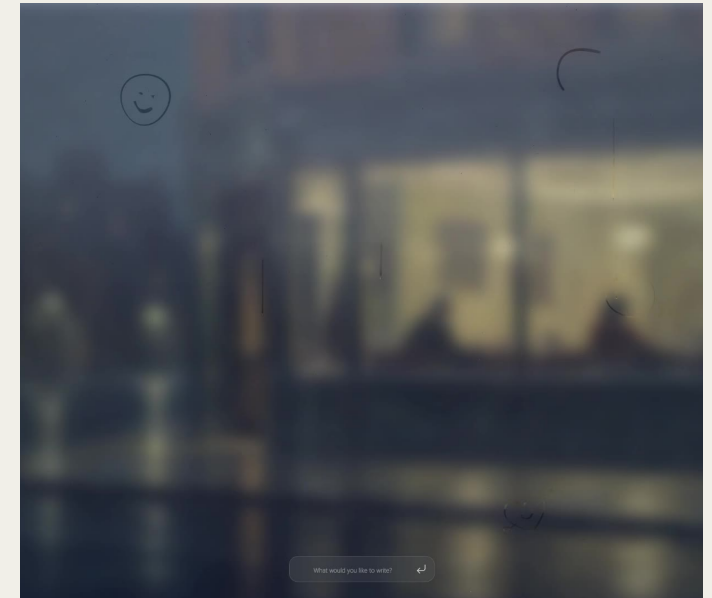
A word is traced on the glass. Pressing Enter begins the search.



02 Gather

00:44 / VIDEO FRAME

Seven neighbouring words emerge gradually, with a soft note for each.



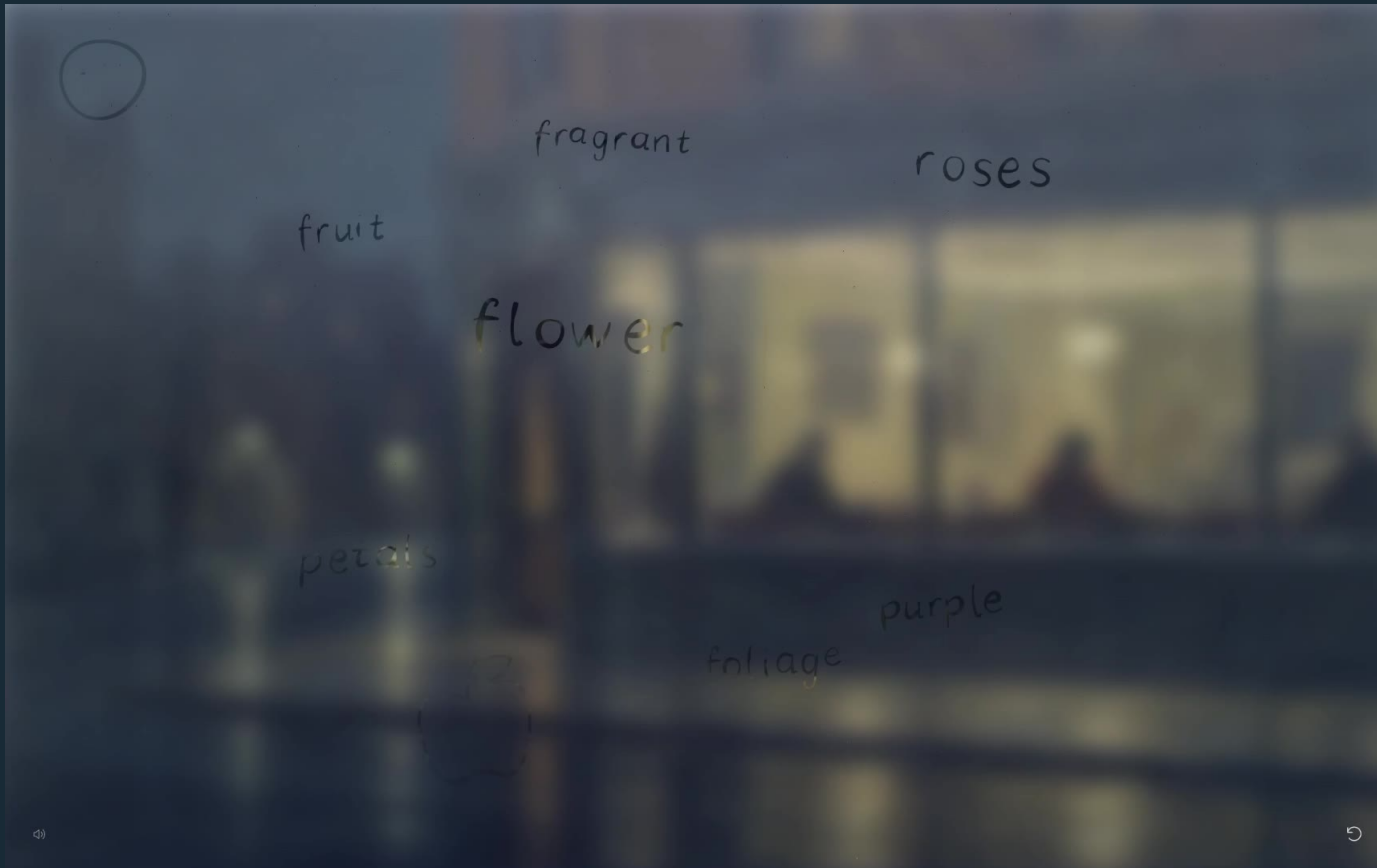
03 Return

00:04 / VIDEO FRAME

The idle surface is the resting state. Results fade and the input returns.

The last panel shows the resting state, not the next chronological frame. The code provides an approximately 6.5-second reading pause after the reveal, followed by a 3.5-second fade.

An atmosphere for words.



00:44 / Recorded interaction

Mist & light

Cool blue-grey condensation softens a warm cafe scene. Moving droplets and reflections give the window depth.

Handwritten marks

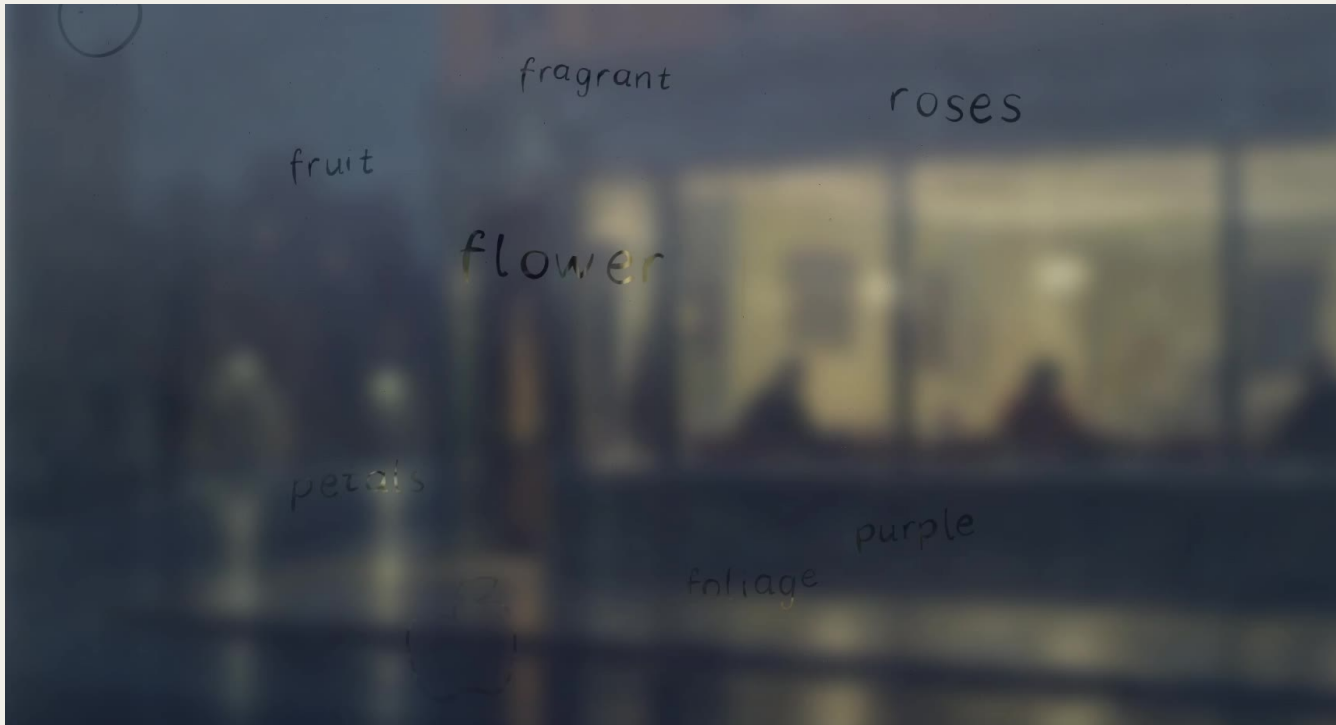
Uneven pressure, small rotations and irregular baselines make each word feel drawn rather than typeset.

Sound & time

Rain and cafe ambience form a continuous background. Quiet notes mark the arrival of related words.

Size and clarity carry the data; the atmosphere gives it an emotional setting.

Association is not explanation.



FLOWERS / 00:44

The recorded cluster includes flower, roses, fragrant, fruit, petals, purple and foliage. It connects a plant to its parts, colour and sensory qualities.

What the image reveals

The result follows an intuitive botanical theme, yet it does more than list synonyms. It brings objects, descriptions and qualities into the same field.

What remains uncertain

The model measures shared language contexts, not a person's memory or intention. A word can evoke several meanings, and a nearby term is not an explanation of why it appeared.

REFLECTION

The fading marks support the idea of passing thoughts. Their low contrast also creates a trade-off: atmosphere is strong, but precise comparison and reading can be harder.

From vectors to traces.

01

One word

English input, 1–20 letters.

02

GloVe

50 dimensions; 400,000 tokens.

03

Seven neighbours

Cosine similarity ranks the results.

VISUAL MAPPING

Size reflects relative similarity within the returned set. Clarity uses the absolute score. Positions are arranged for composition and legibility, not plotted as semantic coordinates. Cosine similarity is not a probability.

IMPLEMENTATION

The original application uses Flask, Gensim and a canvas-based interface. The GitHub edition searches the same normalized vectors in a browser worker, keeping the complete vocabulary. First use downloads about 84 MB.

Explore the work

jasonpipi.github.io/condense-mist/
github.com/jasonpipi/condense-mist

AI ASSISTANCE

AI-assisted project development; semantic results come from pretrained GloVe vectors. This project does not train a new model. The inherited image fallback is AI-generated.

Sources: project code and supplied assignment1.mp4; concept statement by Jianuo Xuan. GloVe: Pennington, Socher & Manning (2014), nlp.stanford.edu/projects/glove/ (PDDL 1.0 data). Water material: Lucas Bebbler / Codrops, RainEffect (2015). Video and ambience: supplied project assets; separate source details were not provided. Screenshots are video keyframes with black side borders cropped. This booklet documents the Mist / word-association assignment only.